

Stoic/grounding techniques specifically for health anxiety during medical uncertainty — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

MAP YOUR ANXIETY

- ☐ **Notice your body's first physical signal when anxiety spikes by paying attention to chest tightness, stomach knotting, racing heart, lightheadedness, or the sensation that something feels internally wrong—physical sensations typically arrive within ninety seconds of a trigger.:** Notice your body's first physical signal when anxiety spikes by paying attention to chest tightness, stomach knotting, racing heart, lightheadedness, or the sensation that something feels internally wrong—physical sensations typically arrive within ninety seconds of a trigger.
- ☐ **Identify which health anxiety thought patterns recur most often for you by replaying recent anxious moments and checking whether catastrophic interpretation, probability distortion, action compulsion, or time compression thoughts show up repeatedly.:** Identify which health anxiety thought patterns recur most often for you by replaying recent anxious moments and checking whether catastrophic interpretation, probability distortion, action compulsion, or time compression thoughts show up repeatedly.
- ☐ **Complete the Anatomy of a Flare-Up worksheet by writing down your physical anxiety signals, thought patterns, specific triggers, and what worsens or improves your symptoms—this becomes your personal flare-up reference guide.:** Complete the Anatomy of a Flare-Up worksheet by writing down your physical anxiety signals, thought patterns, specific triggers, and what worsens or improves your symptoms—this becomes your personal flare-up reference guide.
- ☐ **Keep your completed worksheet somewhere accessible like your phone notes or bedside table so you can reference it when you feel a flare-up starting and remind yourself that you've navigated this before.:** Keep your completed worksheet somewhere accessible like your phone notes or bedside table so you can reference it when you feel a flare-up starting and remind yourself that you've navigated this before.

INTERRUPT THE SPIRAL

- **Catch anxiety at the first link in your chain by checking your worksheet when you notice physical sensations and interrupting the spiral before it fully develops into catastrophizing.:** Catch anxiety at the first link in your chain by checking your worksheet when you notice physical sensations and interrupting the spiral before it fully develops into catastrophizing.
- **Question whether your urge to research symptoms, call your doctor repeatedly, or perform body checks is useful concern or compulsive anxiety-driven behavior that actually makes things worse.:** Question whether your urge to research symptoms, call your doctor repeatedly, or perform body checks is useful concern or compulsive anxiety-driven behavior that actually makes things worse.
- **Practice identifying when you're in probability distortion mode where you believe you're the person bad things happen to despite knowing the statistical odds suggest otherwise—name the distortion to break its power.:** Practice identifying when you're in probability distortion mode where you believe you're the person bad things happen to despite knowing the statistical odds suggest otherwise—name the distortion to break its power.
- **Notice when your thoughts compress time and make waiting feel unbearable by identifying phrases like I won't be able to function or I need to know now as signals that anxiety is escalating.:** Notice when your thoughts compress time and make waiting feel unbearable by identifying phrases like I won't be able to function or I need to know now as signals that anxiety is escalating.

BUILD STOIC STABILITY

- **Practice sitting with medical uncertainty without letting it consume you by accepting that you cannot control the wait time but can control your inner response to each passing day.:** Practice sitting with medical uncertainty without letting it consume you by accepting that you cannot control the wait time but can control your inner response to each passing day.
- **Reframe your anxiety as a normal nervous system response to modern medical ambiguity rather than evidence that something is broken inside you—your brain evolved for tigers, not two-week wait times.:** Reframe your anxiety as a normal nervous system response to modern medical ambiguity rather than evidence that something is broken inside you—your brain evolved for tigers, not two-week wait times.

- ☐ **Distinguish between what you can control and what you cannot by writing down what is within your power versus what depends on doctors, labs, or external timelines that you cannot influence.:** Distinguish between what you can control and what you cannot by writing down what is within your power versus what depends on doctors, labs, or external timelines that you cannot influence.

 - ☐ **Commit to practicing steadiness daily so you can build genuine calm instead of emotional suppression—ataraxia comes from repeated work, not wishful thinking.:** Commit to practicing steadiness daily so you can build genuine calm instead of emotional suppression—ataraxia comes from repeated work, not wishful thinking.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.